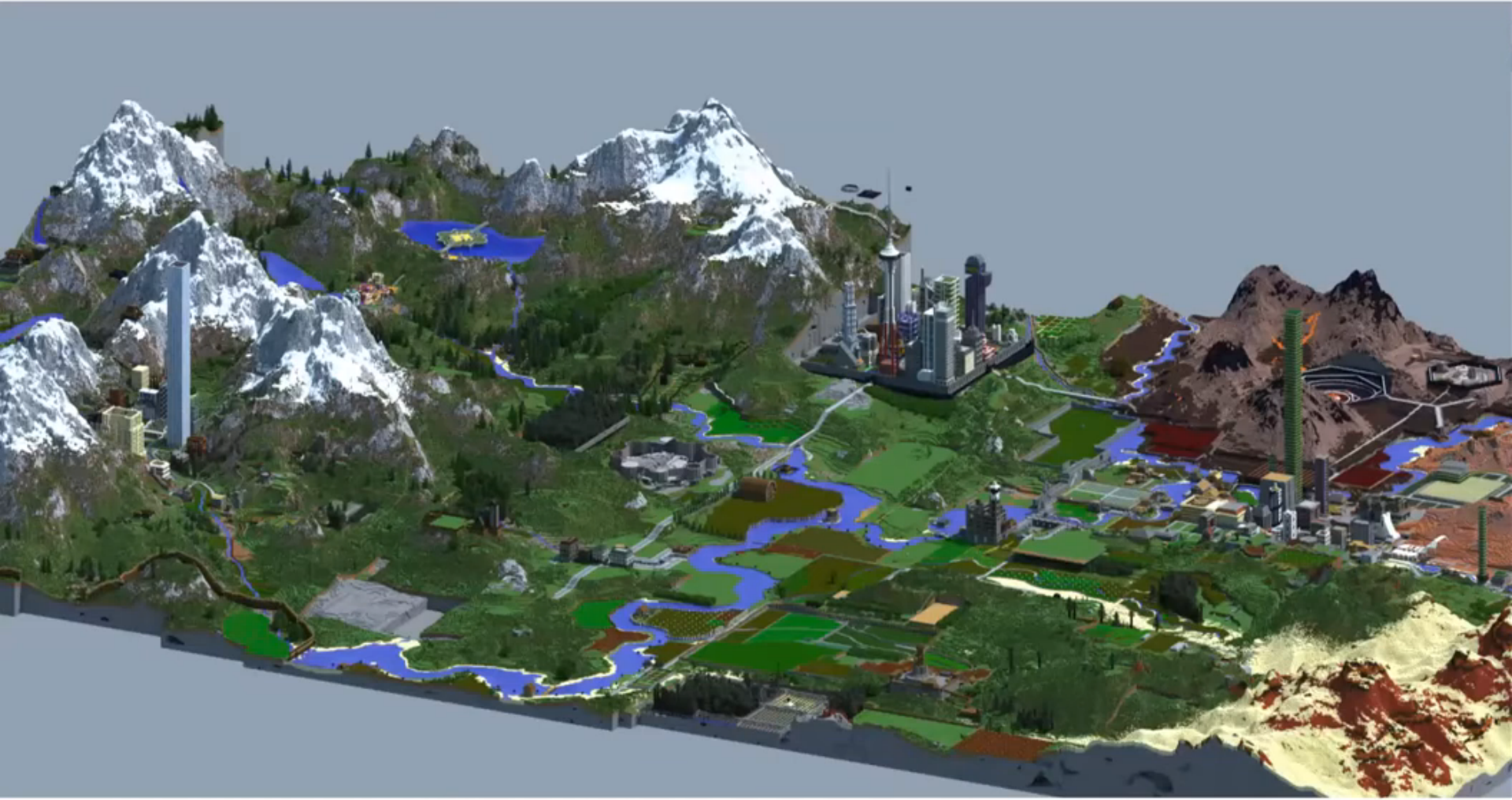
Building a City in a Virtual World

Ceasar Bautista and Lewis Ellis

How we...

- Built a corporate city state in a virtual world
- Established the de-facto trading hub
- Became the richest players in the process
- Learned a lot about how the real world works



What is "Civ"?

- A virtual world, in the form of a Minecraft server with specialized mechanics and plugins
- Sandbox game; no way to win
- "anarchy" server: rules are permissive
  - admins only there to stop cheaters; griefing is "allowed"
- players set their own goals

What can people do?

- Players can reinforce walls, doors, chests, etc, but everything is breakable
- Players can imprison each other, and break out prisoners
- Resources are scarce and geographically distributed
- Substantial production efforts are necessary
- There's no in-game concept of money

What happens in civ

- players form nations, grouping up to produce resources and pursue goals
- players build "vaults", prisons for holding other players
- players form justice systems, government, politics, etc
- players trade resources - an economy forms over time


Duckapore
Crystalis
Bremerhaven
Carbon
Norlund
Agotep (Carbon)
Moloka
Carbon
Sulara
Yggdrasil
TRE
Arelat
Mt Augusta
Wheatistan
Agotep Carbon
Varathia
Otonabee
Cantina
Alexandria
Blackwater
S.P.Q.R
Blackwater
Yggdrasil
Empire Of Yamato
Made By MSPaintDailyYT
7/31/2020
Blackwater
Sesoria
Blackwater
Paradise



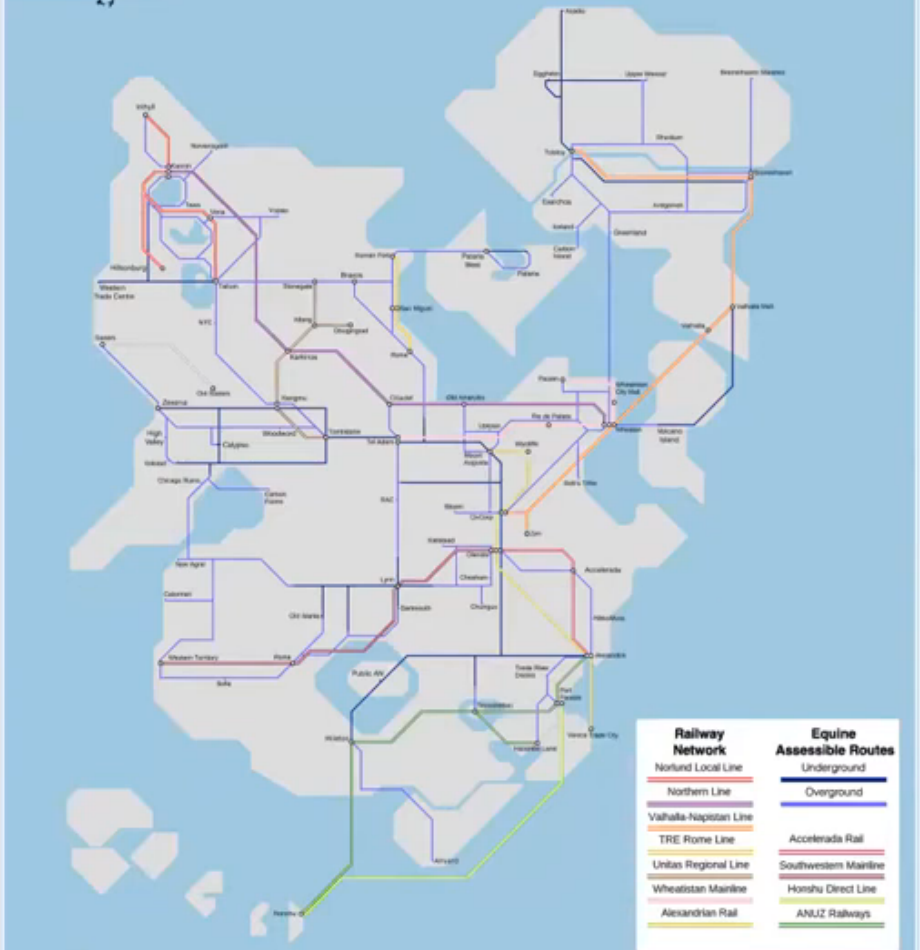




/r/Civrealms Road & Rail Map v3.0

Base Map by DarkyDu, Updated by UnrealJesus & Sadie1373

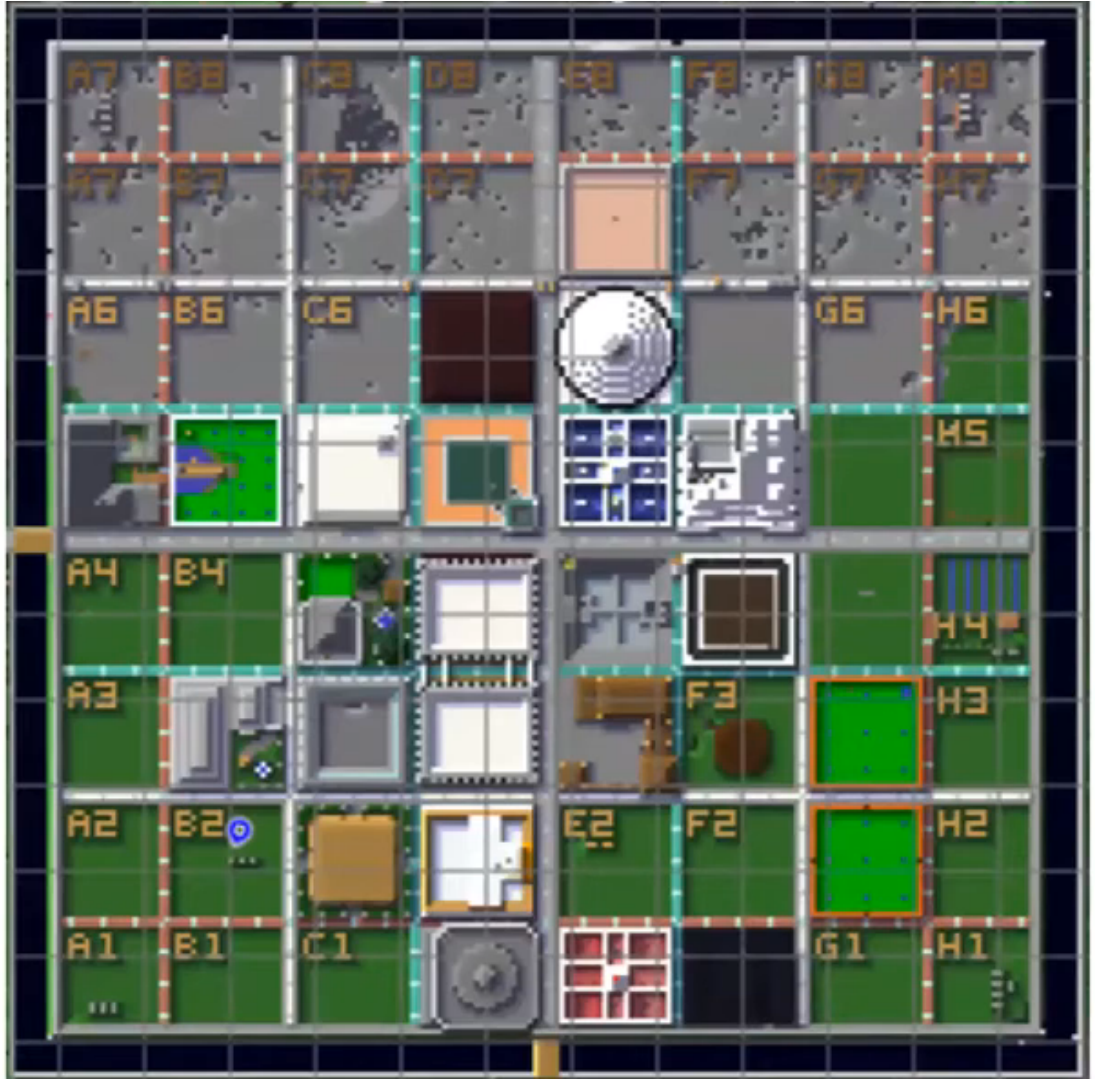
December ~~22~~ 27, 2020



Special Thanks to:

Albyrt, ChChris34, Enna, ieatazz69, Invader, Irok.Iradicus, Mad, Narwhal_19, Noahravn, Terry




A7 B8 C8 D8 E8 F8 G8 H8
A7 B7 C7 D7 F7 G7 H7
A6 B6 C6 G6 H6
H5
A4 B4 H4
A3 F3 H3
A2 B2 E2 F2 H2
A1 B1 C1 G1 H1

CivCorp City

- Designed from ground up to be an international trade hub city
- 8x8 grid of plots, sold initially at cheap early adopter prices
- Design: what makes land valuable?
- Idea of a "place", density of "places"
- Accessibility of commerce

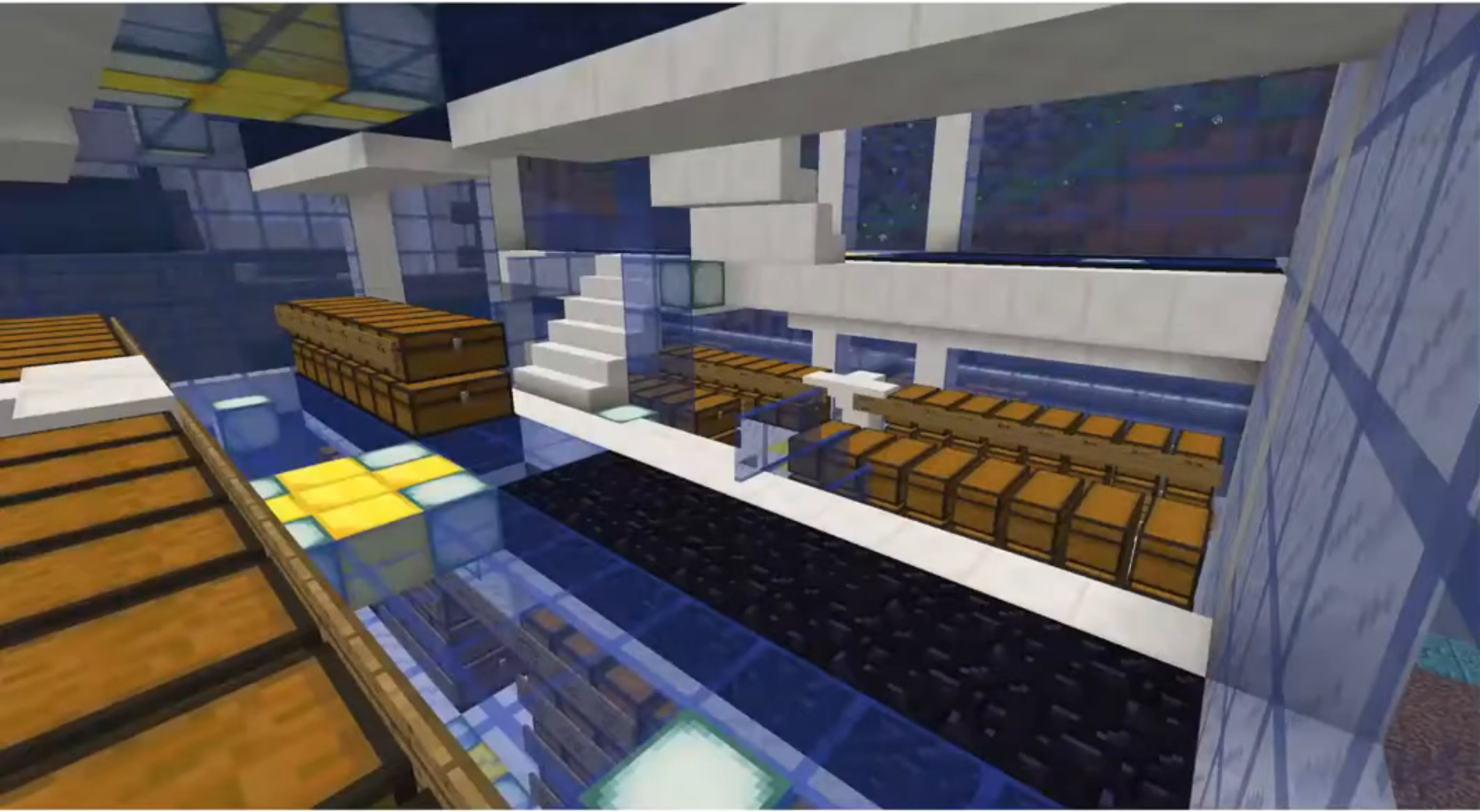
Value Prop

- Land Value Tax: won't become ghost town
- Owning land became a status symbol and investment
  - Plot value was ~50-100 hours of labor
- Well-moderated, secure place for trade
- Justice/legal systems

Marketplace

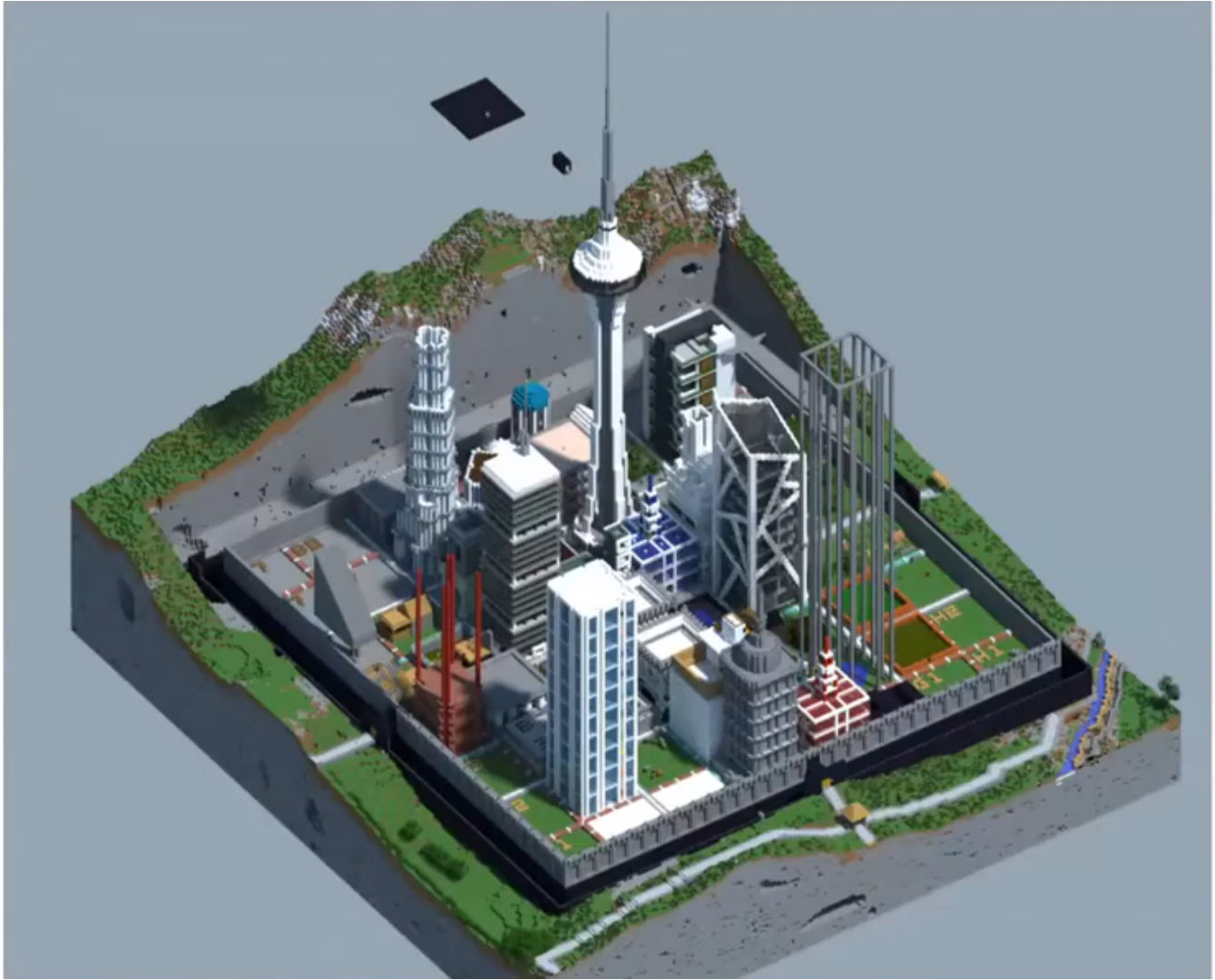
- We were the commodity exchange
  - 6 core crops, grown in different limited regions
  - People travel to trade their crops for whatever they need
- Manufacturing center / commodity colonies model
- We unlocked specialization: produce 1 thing, trade for everything else
- We unlocked coordination: prices fluctuate

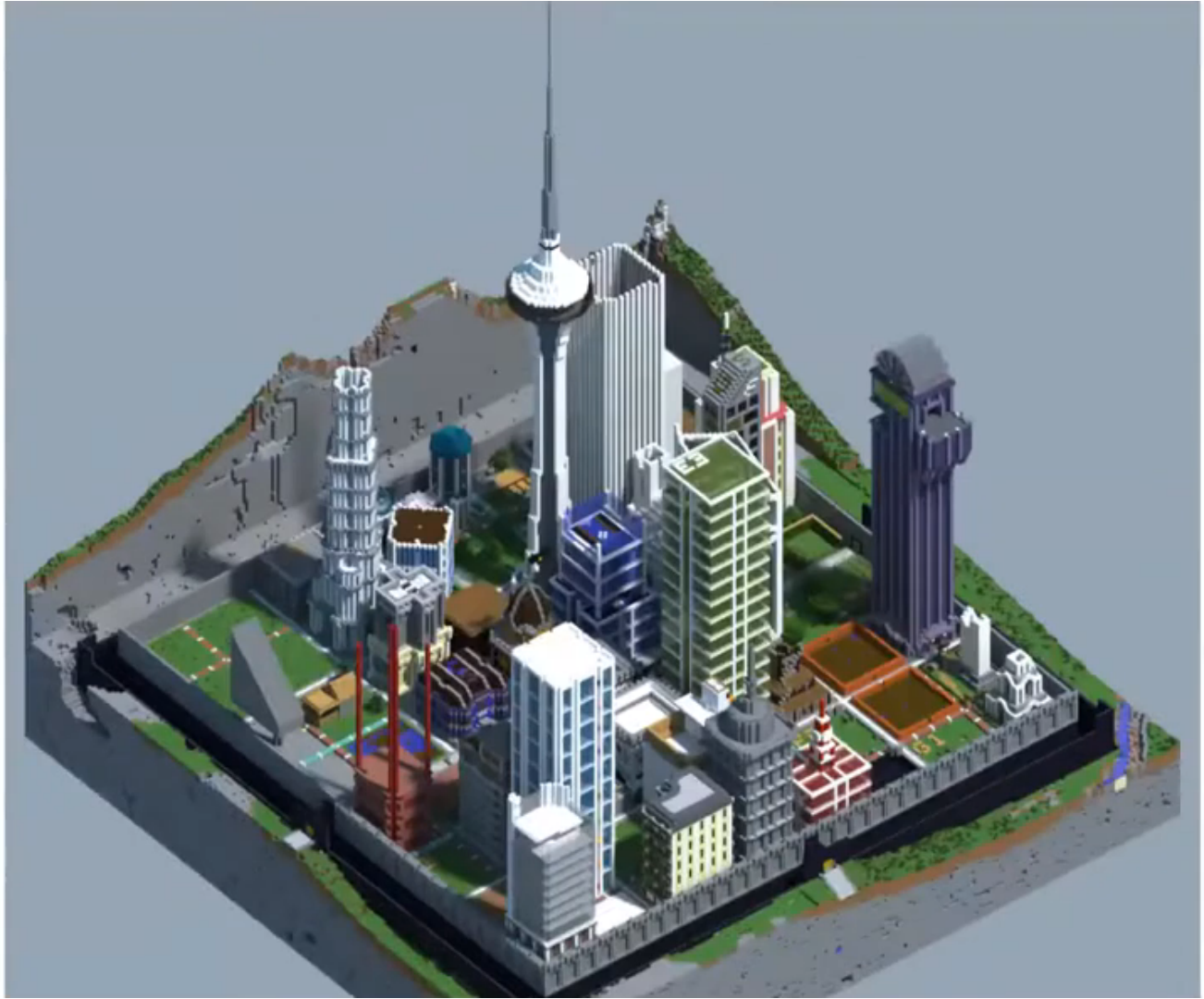





Wheat
12/15
Wheat
15/18
Wheat
20/24









Getting rich

- nobody gets rich as a laborer selling their time
- nobody gets rich competing on margin: "competition is for losers"
- monopolies are how you get rich
- so "how to get rich" becomes "how to create a monopoly"

Making a monopoly

- Buy 3 properties of same color
- Critical thinking to identify opportunities
  - see it first, or do it better
  - defensible, scalable

Monopolies

- XP trade: capital moat, scale + network effects
- valuable land: reinvest in city, network effects, flywheel
- donkeys
- obsidian
- glass manufacturing
- casino

Rich people problems

- IRL, we take it for granted that money can be invested at all
- Eventually we got richer faster than we could figure out what to do with it

Rich people problems

- Turning money into manpower (buying labor) is hard
- Communication overhead, trust, followthrough
- Management / general contractors provide this

Rich people problems

- Want to invest in things, just need good things to invest in
- Capital not bottleneck
  - Ideas/execution/competent people are
  - This is the VC problem

Value of virtual world in education

- Ideas are easy to read about, but hard to put into practice IRL
- Putting ideas into practice and seeing outcomes builds intuition and understanding
- Lots of things become intuitively obvious
- Became motivating to read and study these subjects: could actually put it into practice